WIA GOOGLE ADS PLAYBOOK

Purpose

Use this Playbook whenever researching, planning, building, writing, reviewing, analyzing, troubleshooting, or optimizing Google Ads for a Wedding Industry Ads client.

This document defines **Wedding Industry Ads' Google Ads methodology and decision-making framework**.

It should be used alongside:

1. The client's **Client Marketing Profile**
2. Approved client source materials
3. The client's landing page and/or **WIA Landing Page Playbook**
4. Keyword research and Google forecasts when available
5. Current Google Ads account data when available
6. Lead-quality and booking data when available

The goal is not simply to generate clicks or conversions inside Google Ads.

The goal is to use Google Ads to connect the client's business with qualified prospective customers who are actively searching for what they offer and ultimately contribute to qualified inquiries and booked business.

---

1. THREE LEVELS OF DECISION-MAKING

Not every recommendation in this Playbook should be treated the same way.

WIA Standard

A documented WIA practice that should generally guide strategy unless the specific account provides a reason to deviate.

WIA Decision Framework

A documented way WIA evaluates a situation. The correct action depends on account data and client circumstances.

Client / Account-Specific Decision

A decision that must be based on the individual client's goals, market, budget, offer, account history, search behavior, and performance.

Do not turn examples, benchmarks, or troubleshooting tactics into universal rules.

---

2. CORE GOOGLE SEARCH PHILOSOPHY

WIA Standard

Google Search campaigns are primarily used to capture **high-intent existing demand**.

The strategy is fundamentally different from advertising designed primarily to generate awareness.

Search campaigns allow WIA to reach people who are already searching for the client's services.

The primary objective for most WIA Search campaigns is **leads**.

Every decision should therefore prioritize:

Relevant searches → qualified traffic → inquiries → qualified leads → bookings

Traffic volume alone is not success.

---

3. START WITH THE CLIENT

Before developing Google Ads strategy, review the Client Marketing Profile and approved source materials.

Determine:

- What the business actually offers
- Priority service(s)
- Ideal customer
- Geographic service area
- Geographic markets the client wants to attract
- How customers describe the service
- Meaningful differentiators
- Client priorities
- Pricing or investment positioning when documented
- Qualification criteria
- Services the business does NOT offer
- Relevant specialties
- Primary conversion action
- Business goals
- Existing advertising history when available
- Landing page destination

- Available budget

Do not begin with a generic list of wedding-industry keywords and try to fit the client into it.

Start with the client.

---

4. DEFINE THE BUSINESS OBJECTIVE

For most WIA Search campaigns, the objective is lead generation.

Define what a meaningful conversion means for this specific client.

Depending on the business, this may include:

- Inquiry form submission
- Availability request
- Tour request
- Consultation request
- Qualified phone call
- Other documented lead action

Where downstream information is available, distinguish:

Conversion → Lead → Qualified Lead → Booking

Do not assume every Google Ads conversion has equal business value.

---

5. SEARCH INTENT COMES FIRST

Before recommending a keyword, ask:

What is the likely intent behind this search?

A keyword being related to weddings or the client's industry does not automatically make it valuable.

Prioritize searches that indicate someone may actively be looking for the service the client provides.

Evaluate:

- Commercial intent
- Relevance
- Geographic fit
- Specificity

- Search volume
- Potential cost
- Qualification
- Available conversion data

The goal is not to appear for every related search.

The goal is to appear for searches with a reasonable likelihood of producing the type of customer the client wants.

---

6. THINK LIKE THE CUSTOMER

Keywords are the terms added to the Google Ads account.

Search terms are the actual phrases people type into Google.

Do not assume prospective clients use the same terminology as wedding professionals.

Consider different ways customers may describe the same need.

Use:

- Client reviews
- FAQs
- Website language
- Voice of Customer research
- Client Marketing Profile
- Existing search-term data
- Keyword research tools

to understand how real prospective clients search.

---

7. KEYWORD RESEARCH

Evaluate potential keywords using:

Relevance

Does the client actually provide what this searcher appears to want?

Intent

Does the search indicate a reasonable likelihood of hiring or booking?

Geography

Does it align with the client's desired market?

Search Volume

Is there meaningful demand?

Cost

What does available forecasting suggest about CPC and budget requirements?

Qualification

Could this search reasonably produce the type of inquiry the client wants?

Do not choose keywords solely because they have high search volume.

Do not reject lower-volume keywords solely because they have lower volume when they demonstrate strong intent.

---

8. KEYWORD INTENT CLASSIFICATION

When useful, classify potential keywords into:

High Intent

Strong indication that someone is actively looking for the client's service.

Prioritize these when search volume and budget allow.

Moderate Intent

Relevant searches where commercial intent is less explicit.

These may warrant testing depending on the client and available budget.

Low / Informational Intent

Searches primarily indicating research, education, DIY behavior, employment, inspiration, or another objective unlikely to result in hiring the client.

Generally deprioritize or exclude unless account data demonstrates value.

Always allow actual performance data to challenge assumptions about intent.

---

9. CAMPAIGN & AD GROUP STRUCTURE

Client / Account-Specific Decision

Campaign and ad-group structure should reflect meaningful differences in:

- Search intent
- Service
- Geography
- Offer
- Budget priority
- Ad messaging
- Landing page destination

Group keywords together when they can reasonably share the same search intent, ad message, and landing-page experience.

Do not overcomplicate the account simply to create additional campaigns or ad groups.

At the same time, do not combine materially different searches when doing so weakens relevance.

Structure should support:

Search → Keyword → Ad → Landing Page

alignment.

---

10. GEOGRAPHIC TARGETING

Geographic targeting must reflect the client's actual business strategy.

Consider:

- Physical business location
- Service area
- Desired customer location
- Destination market
- Search behavior
- Historical performance

Do not assume the client's physical location and desired customer's location are the same.

WIA Standard

When appropriate, WIA uses the location option:

Presence: People in or regularly in your included location

rather than automatically targeting people who have merely shown interest in that location.

This is particularly important when controlling traffic quality or troubleshooting spam.

If broader location-interest targeting is intentionally required, evaluate exclusions and performance carefully.

---

11. BUDGET STRATEGY

Budget should be evaluated in the context of:

- Search volume
- CPC
- Competition
- Geography
- Number of campaigns
- Client priorities
- Conversion opportunity
- Historical performance

WIA Budget Guidance

WIA's documented best-practice guidance identifies:

$1,000/month as the preferred starting budget for Google Search campaigns.

WIA generally recommends avoiding monthly Search budgets below approximately:

$500/month

because insufficient budget may generate spend without enough traffic or data to produce meaningful results.

These are WIA planning benchmarks, not guarantees of performance.

Never promise that a particular budget will generate a specific number of leads or bookings.

---

12. GOOGLE FORECASTS

Use Google forecasts to provide planning context around:

- Search demand
- Estimated clicks
- CPC
- Budget requirements
- Geographic opportunity

Forecasts are estimates.

They are not promises or performance guarantees.

Use them as one input in the strategy rather than treating Google's projections as expected results.

---

13. BIDDING STRATEGY

WIA's Google Ads Strategy & Budget template identifies **Maximize Conversions** as a standard Search bidding strategy.

However, bidding decisions should still consider:

- Campaign objective
- Account history
- Available conversion data
- Tracking reliability
- Budget
- Search volume
- Campaign maturity

WIA Standard

If changing bid strategy within an existing campaign, WIA generally prefers modifying the existing campaign rather than rebuilding it solely for that purpose so Google can retain useful campaign history.

If the actual campaign objective changes materially, WIA's documented practice is to create a new campaign, using the existing campaign as a starting point when appropriate.

Do not change bidding strategy merely because Google recommends doing so.

---

14. NEGATIVE KEYWORD PHILOSOPHY

Negative keywords protect budget by preventing ads from showing for irrelevant searches.

But WIA does **not** treat every unexpected search as a negative keyword.

WIA Decision Framework

Before excluding a search term, evaluate:

1. Is it actually unrelated to what the client offers?
2. What appears to be the searcher's intent?
3. Did the term generate clicks?
4. Did it generate conversions?
5. What was the cost?
6. Could the term represent an unexpected but valuable way customers search?
7. Are competitors advertising against the search?

A strange-looking search term is not automatically a bad search term.

Actual conversion performance matters.

---

15. ADDING NEGATIVE KEYWORDS

Add a negative keyword when available evidence indicates the search is genuinely irrelevant or undesirable.

Common categories may include:

- Jobs/employment
- DIY searches
- Free services
- Education/training
- Templates
- Unrelated products/services
- Irrelevant locations
- Services the client does not provide

But do not automatically apply every category to every client.

Something irrelevant for one wedding professional may be valuable for another.

---

16. DO NOT OVER-EXCLUDE

WIA Standard

Avoid adding large numbers of negative keywords impulsively.

Over-excluding can unnecessarily restrict reach and may disrupt performance.

If campaign performance declines after negative keywords are added, review whether valuable searches were accidentally excluded.

Negative keywords can be removed when necessary.

Make changes intentionally and evaluate their effect.

---

17. KEYWORD TROUBLESHOOTING

If a keyword is spending disproportionately without producing desired results:

Step 1: Check Search Terms

Determine what actual searches are triggering the keyword.

Step 2: Address Irrelevant Queries

If only certain search terms are irrelevant, add appropriate negatives.

When relevant, use the most appropriate scope, including ad-group-level negatives where the issue is specific to that ad group.

Step 3: Evaluate the Keyword

If the keyword repeatedly triggers a large number of irrelevant searches or performs poorly despite reasonable optimization, consider pausing it.

WIA Standard

Prefer **pausing rather than deleting** keywords when possible so historical account data remains available.

New keywords can be added when strategically appropriate.

---

18. COMPETITOR SEARCH TERMS

Do not automatically exclude competitor names.

WIA recognizes that appearing alongside competitors may give prospective customers an opportunity to compare options and choose the client.

Evaluate competitor-related searches based on:

- Intent
- Cost
- Conversion performance
- Relevance
- Overall strategy

Do not assume competitor traffic is inherently good or bad.

Let strategy and performance guide the decision.

---

19. RESPONSIVE SEARCH ADS

Google dynamically combines Responsive Search Ad headlines and descriptions.

Create a varied collection of messages rather than repeating one idea with minor wording changes.

Use available space strategically across themes such as:

Search Relevance

What does the client offer?

Geography

Where do they serve?

Differentiation

Why choose them?

Benefits

What does the prospective customer care about?

Credibility

What documented proof reduces uncertainty?

CTA

What should the searcher do next?

Respect current Google Ads character limits.

Never invent stronger claims simply to fill available headline slots.

---

20. GOOGLE ADS COPY STANDARDS

Google Ads copy should reflect the client's Brand Voice while remaining clear, concise, and search-oriented.

Use:

- Relevant service language
- Client-specific differentiators
- Geographic language when useful
- Concrete benefits
- Documented proof
- Natural CTAs
- Customer terminology

Avoid:

- Generic wedding clichés
- Keyword stuffing
- Unsupported "best" claims
- Empty superlatives
- Artificial urgency
- Repetitive headlines
- Generic AI marketing language
- Claims not supported by client materials

Ask:

Could a competitor use this exact ad by changing only the business name?

If yes, look for stronger client-specific messaging.

---

21. EDITING LIVE SEARCH ADS

WIA Standard

Evergreen ads should generally remain running rather than being repeatedly turned off and back on without strategic reason.

Responsive Search Ad headlines and descriptions can be edited, but WIA's documented practice for keeping performance data clean is to:

1. Duplicate the existing Responsive Search Ad
2. Make the desired edits in the duplicate
3. Launch the new version
4. Pause the old version

Do not delete historical ads simply because new copy is being tested.

---

22. AD ASSETS

Where available and strategically relevant, use Google Ads assets such as:

- Sitelinks
- Images
- Other applicable assets

WIA strongly recommends adding images when the account and campaign allow them.

Assets should support the campaign's conversion objective and provide useful information.

Do not add assets merely to satisfy Google's recommendations.

---

23. LANDING PAGE ALIGNMENT

Google Ads and the landing page should work as one experience.

The landing page should reinforce:

- What the person searched for
- Service relevance
- Geographic relevance
- The ad's promise
- Client differentiation

- The intended conversion action

Follow the **WIA Landing Page Playbook** when creating or evaluating the page.

WIA generally favors a dedicated ads landing page or strategically adapted page rather than sending Search traffic to a generic homepage.

---

24. CONVERSION TRACKING

Conversion tracking is essential.

Configure and evaluate conversions based on meaningful actions such as:

- Inquiry submissions
- Availability requests
- Tour requests
- Other documented lead actions

When analyzing performance, segment by **Conversion Action** when useful so the specific actions contributing to reported conversions can be understood.

Do not evaluate "Conversions" as one undifferentiated number when multiple actions are being tracked.

---

25. THE WIA PERFORMANCE FUNNEL

Analyze Google Ads performance as a connected funnel:

Impressions → Clicks → Conversions → Qualified Leads → Bookings

No single metric tells the whole story.

When downstream data is available, use it.

A campaign generating fewer leads at a higher cost may still be more valuable if those leads are substantially more qualified or more likely to book.

---

26. CORE METRICS

Impressions

How many times ads were shown.

Useful for context, but not a primary success metric on its own.

Clicks

How many people clicked.

Evaluate in relation to impressions, budget, CPC, and conversions.

Click-Through Rate (CTR)

The percentage of impressions resulting in clicks.

WIA benchmark:

3–5% = common/average range
Above 5% = generally good

A strong CTR can indicate good alignment among searches, keywords, and ad copy.

Cost Per Click (CPC)

Average cost for a click.

WIA training materials note that CPC may commonly begin around $1–$2.50, but competition, market, bidding strategy, and intent can drive it higher.

Higher CPC is not automatically a problem if the traffic is highly qualified and converts efficiently.

Conversion Rate

Percentage of clicks resulting in conversions.

WIA benchmarks:

10%+ = Excellent
Around 5% = Average/Good
Below approximately 3.5% = May need attention

Treat these as diagnostic benchmarks, not universal performance requirements.

Conversions

The total number of tracked conversion actions.

Always understand which conversion actions are included.

Cost Per Conversion / Cost Per Lead

How much advertising spend is required to generate a conversion.

Evaluate this in the context of:

- Lead quality
- Client pricing
- Booking rate
- Customer value
- Business economics

Do not judge cost per lead without context.

---

27. IMPRESSION SHARE

Search Impression Share helps show how often the client's ads are appearing relative to eligible searches.

When diagnosing limited visibility, review:

Search Lost Impression Share: Budget

Indicates how much potential visibility is being lost because of insufficient budget.

WIA training notes that approximately 40%+ lost due to budget may be meaningful evidence that budget is limiting campaign opportunity.

Search Lost Impression Share: Rank

Indicates visibility being lost because of Ad Rank.

Investigate factors such as:

- Ad relevance
- Headline quality
- Landing page quality

- Overall ad quality/strength

Do not automatically increase budget simply because impression share is low.

Determine **why** visibility is being lost.

---

28. WEEKLY PERFORMANCE REVIEW

WIA Standard

Google Ads should generally be reviewed approximately **once per week**.

For lower-budget campaigns, recognize that one week may provide limited data.

During weekly reviews, evaluate:

1. Campaign-level performance
2. CTR
3. CPC
4. Conversions
5. Conversion rate
6. Cost per conversion
7. Search terms
8. Budget and impression-share context
9. Demographic/location data when relevant
10. Ad performance/content periodically

Avoid reacting to one metric without considering the rest of the account.

Context is everything.

---

29. SEARCH TERM REVIEW

Search-term analysis is one of WIA's most important ongoing optimization practices.

Ask:

- What are people actually searching?
- Are those searches relevant?
- What intent do they demonstrate?
- Which terms are generating clicks?
- Which are generating conversions?
- Which are wasting spend?

- Are unexpected searches actually profitable?
- Are new keyword opportunities emerging?

Search-term analysis should inform:

- Negative keywords
- New keywords
- Keyword pauses
- Ad messaging
- Campaign/ad-group structure
- Landing page messaging

---

30. DEMOGRAPHIC ANALYSIS

When sufficient data exists, review:

- Age
- Gender
- Household income

Use performance data rather than assumptions to determine whether demographic adjustments are warranted.

Demographic targeting can be modified without necessarily rebuilding the campaign.

Major targeting changes may require time for Google's algorithm to adjust.

WIA materials note that significant changes may take approximately **2–4 weeks** to fully settle.

Avoid repeatedly making major changes before the previous change has had time to generate useful evidence.

---

31. BID ADJUSTMENTS

WIA uses bid adjustments to place more or less emphasis on segments based on performance.

Potential adjustment categories include:

- Audience segments
- Demographics
- Household income
- Locations

WIA Decision Framework

Increase emphasis when a segment demonstrates stronger conversion performance.

Decrease emphasis when a segment consistently costs more while generating weak or no conversion performance.

Do not adjust bids simply because a segment intuitively seems like a better customer.

Use data.

---

32. LOCATION PERFORMANCE

Review where clicks and conversions are actually coming from.

If certain locations materially outperform others, location-level optimization may be appropriate.

Do not make geographic bid decisions based solely on assumptions about affluent areas or where the "ideal customer" should live.

Actual performance should guide optimization.

---

33. DEVICE PERFORMANCE

Review performance by device when useful.

If clicks are disproportionately coming from mobile but conversions are weak, investigate the mobile landing-page experience before assuming the traffic itself is the problem.

Evaluate:

- Page speed
- Mobile layout
- Form usability
- CTA visibility
- Other conversion friction

Traffic and landing-page performance must be evaluated together.

---

34. AUCTION INSIGHTS

Auction Insights can provide information about other advertisers competing for the same searches.

Use this for context.

Competitors may include major wedding marketplaces as well as local businesses.

When useful, review competitor landing pages to understand the experience searchers are comparing against.

Do not simply imitate competitor messaging or strategy.

---

35. MAKING CHANGES

Do not optimize simply because "something should be changed."

Before recommending a change, identify:

Problem → Evidence → Likely Cause → Recommended Action → Metric to Monitor

Example:

Problem: Cost per conversion increased.

Evidence: Search-term report shows increased spend on irrelevant searches.

Likely Cause: Keyword matching is bringing in poorly aligned queries.

Action: Add specific negative keywords and evaluate the responsible keyword(s).

Monitor: Search-term quality, conversions, and cost per conversion.

Every meaningful optimization recommendation should have a reason.

---

36. DO NOT OVER-OPTIMIZE

Google Ads requires enough data and time to evaluate changes.

Avoid:

- Constantly changing budgets
- Repeatedly turning campaigns on/off
- Adding large negative lists impulsively
- Making multiple major changes without understanding which affected performance
- Reacting emotionally to a few days of data

Where possible, document meaningful changes so later performance shifts can be interpreted correctly.

---

37. BUDGET CHANGES

Budget is controlled at the campaign level.

Google may frequently recommend increasing spend.

WIA Standard

Do not increase budget simply because Google recommends it.

If the client is satisfied with results, maintaining the existing budget can be appropriate.

Use:

- Conversion performance
- Lead quality
- Search opportunity
- Lost impression share due to budget
- Client goals
- Available resources

to determine whether increasing spend makes strategic sense.

---

38. GOOGLE'S AUTOMATED RECOMMENDATIONS

WIA Standard

Treat Google recommendations as suggestions, not instructions.

Automated recommendations are not necessarily tailored to:

- The client's business

- Budget
- Wedding-industry context
- Lead quality
- Business goals
- WIA strategy

Do not make changes merely to improve Google's Optimization Score.

Actual business results matter more.

---

39. GOOGLE REPRESENTATIVES

Google representatives may contact advertisers with optimization suggestions.

WIA recommends caution.

Do not implement recommendations during a call simply because they come from a Google representative.

Document the recommendation and evaluate it against:

- Client strategy
- Account data
- Budget
- Lead quality
- Business goals

Platform incentives do not necessarily align perfectly with client ROI.

---

40. SPAM LEAD TROUBLESHOOTING

If Google Ads begins producing significant spam, investigate systematically rather than assuming the entire campaign is failing.

Step 1: Protect the Form

Confirm appropriate spam protection such as reCAPTCHA is installed.

Recognize that sophisticated automated submissions may still bypass basic bot protection.

Step 2: Review Network Performance

Segment campaign performance by network.

Investigate whether disproportionate spam conversions are coming from Search Partners or Display rather than Google Search.

If network traffic appears to be causing the issue, adjust network settings appropriately.

Step 3: Review Location Settings

Confirm targeting is configured appropriately.

WIA generally recommends:

Presence: People in or regularly in your included location

for tighter geographic control.

Where broader interest-based targeting is necessary, consider appropriate geographic exclusions.

Step 4: Review Keywords and Search Terms

Look for:

- One keyword consuming disproportionate spend
- Keywords generating unusual numbers of conversions
- Search terms consistently associated with spam

When CRM attribution is available, use it to connect spam leads back to their keyword/search source.

Step 5: Review Automated Campaign Types

Performance Max, Display, and Demand Gen may provide less manual control and can become vulnerable to spam patterns.

If automated campaigns are generating substantial spam:

- Consider pausing them temporarily
- Reduce budget while investigating
- Prioritize Search where greater control is needed

Step 6: Review Unknown Age

When spam is significant, investigate the **Unknown** age segment.

If evidence shows spam is concentrated there, exclusion may be appropriate.

Do not automatically exclude Unknown from every account without evidence.

Step 7: Escalate if Necessary

If significant spend has been consumed by demonstrably fraudulent/spam traffic, contact Google Ads support and investigate available remedies.

---

41. DISPLAY CAMPAIGNS

Display campaigns serve a different strategic role from Search.

Search

Primarily captures existing high-intent demand.

Display

Can be used for:

- Brand awareness
- Additional impressions
- Retargeting
- Reaching audiences across Google's display network

Display clicks may cost considerably less than Search clicks and campaigns may operate with smaller daily budgets.

Do not evaluate Search and Display by identical expectations.

---

42. DISPLAY TARGETING OPTIONS

Depending on strategy, Display campaigns may use:

- Audience segments
- Retargeting / first-party data
- Demographics
- Placements
- Locations
- Device targeting

Placements can allow targeting of specific websites, YouTube channels, or apps.

Content exclusions should be considered to protect brand suitability.

Display strategy should be intentionally designed around its objective rather than added simply because Google makes the campaign type available.

---

43. REPORTING

Track performance consistently over comparable periods.

WIA's reporting methodology emphasizes campaign-level performance for understanding the overall picture.

Record relevant metrics such as:

- Spend
- Impressions
- Clicks
- CPC
- CTR
- Conversions
- Conversion rate
- Cost per conversion

When useful, also track:

- Top-performing keywords
- Significant optimization changes
- Budget changes
- Other context that may explain performance movement

Do not compare inconsistent date ranges without acknowledging the difference.

---

44. INTERPRETING PERFORMANCE

Use diagnostic reasoning.

Low Impressions

Investigate:

- Search volume
- Budget
- Targeting
- Keyword eligibility
- Rank

- Campaign structure

Impressions but Low CTR

Investigate:

- Search relevance
- Keyword intent
- Ad messaging
- Competition

Clicks but Few Conversions

Investigate:

- Search-term quality
- Keyword intent
- Landing page
- Offer
- Conversion friction
- Tracking

Conversions but Poor Lead Quality

Investigate:

- Search terms
- Keywords
- Networks
- Geography
- Qualification
- Messaging
- Landing page
- Spam

Qualified Leads but Few Bookings

Do not automatically diagnose this as an advertising problem.

Where available, investigate:

- Sales process
- Lead response
- Follow-up
- Pricing fit
- Lead qualification

- Booking data

Google Ads performance and sales performance are connected but are not identical.

---

45. SOURCE INTEGRITY

Client-specific claims must come from approved client materials.

Never invent:

- Awards
- Pricing
- Service areas
- Years of experience
- Reviews
- Results
- Credentials
- Inclusions
- Guarantees
- Differentiators

Distinguish:

Documented Client Fact

May be stated as fact.

Voice of Customer

May inform messaging.

Strategic Interpretation

May inform recommendations but should not become an unsupported claim.

Google Ads Data

May inform decisions but should not be treated as proof of causation without sufficient evidence.

WIA Benchmark

Provides context, not a guaranteed performance requirement.

---

46. WHEN ASKED TO CREATE A GOOGLE ADS STRATEGY

First determine:

Business Goal:
What does the client want Google Ads to accomplish?

Primary Conversion:
What meaningful action should campaigns generate?

Priority Services:
What should be advertised?

Ideal Customer:
Who should campaigns attract?

Geography:
Where should customers come from?

Search Intent:
What would qualified customers search?

Budget:
What resources are available?

Landing Page:
Where will traffic go?

Tracking:
What can be measured?

Historical Data:
What does the account already tell us?

If essential information is unavailable, identify the gap.

Do not invent it.

---

47. GOOGLE ADS STRATEGY OUTPUT

Unless instructed otherwise, provide:

Strategic Summary

What WIA is trying to accomplish and why.

Campaign Structure

Recommended campaigns and rationale.

Ad Groups

Recommended search-intent groupings.

Keyword Strategy

Priority keyword themes and rationale.

Negative Keyword Strategy

Known exclusions plus areas requiring monitoring.

Geographic Strategy

Recommended targeting based on documented market.

Budget Strategy

Allocation and available forecast context.

Bidding Strategy

Recommended approach and rationale.

Conversion Strategy

What should be tracked.

Landing Page

Recommended destination and alignment requirements.

Ad Messaging

Core themes derived from client positioning.

Assets

Recommended applicable assets.

Measurement Plan

What should be monitored after launch.

Clearly label recommendations requiring additional research or account data.

---

48. WHEN ASKED TO CREATE GOOGLE ADS COPY

Use:

- Client Marketing Profile
- Approved client materials
- Campaign/ad group
- Keyword strategy
- Search intent
- Landing page
- This Playbook

Provide final recommended Responsive Search Ad copy within Google's current character limits.

Include strategically varied:

- Headlines
- Descriptions
- Requested assets

Do not produce dozens of generic alternatives merely to fill space.

Prioritize the strongest client-specific messages.

---

49. WHEN ASKED TO ANALYZE A GOOGLE ADS ACCOUNT

Do not immediately recommend changes.

First analyze:

1. Date range
2. Spend
3. Impressions
4. Clicks
5. CTR
6. CPC
7. Conversions by conversion action
8. Conversion rate
9. Cost per conversion
10. Impression share where available
11. Lost impression share due to budget/rank
12. Search terms
13. Keyword performance
14. Campaign/ad-group performance
15. Geography
16. Demographics when relevant
17. Devices when relevant
18. Network performance when relevant
19. Lead quality when available
20. Bookings/revenue when available

Then identify:

What's working

What needs attention

What additional information is needed

What should change now

What should continue gathering data

Do not recommend changes simply for the sake of optimization.

---

50. FINAL QUALITY CONTROL

Before delivering strategy, copy, or optimization recommendations, verify:

Search Intent

Are we reaching people likely to want the client's service?

Relevance

Does the ad match what they're searching for?

Qualification

Are we attracting the right customer rather than merely maximizing volume?

Geography

Does targeting reflect the client's actual market?

Budget

Is the strategy realistic for available spend?

Differentiation

Does messaging provide a real reason to choose this client?

Landing Page

Does the destination continue the same conversation?

Tracking

Can meaningful outcomes be measured?

Evidence

Are optimization recommendations supported by actual data?

Lead Quality

Are we considering what happens after the conversion when that information is available?

Accuracy

Are factual claims supported?

Voice

Does the copy sound like the client?

Specificity

Could a competitor use the same strategy or copy unchanged?

If so, make it more client-specific.

CORE WIA PRINCIPLE

Do not optimize Google Ads for Google. Optimize Google Ads for the client's business.

Google's recommendations, benchmarks, CTR, conversion rate, CPC, Optimization Score, and other platform metrics are useful diagnostic information.

They are not the ultimate objective.

The objective is to use paid search efficiently to reach people actively looking for what the client offers and turn that demand into qualified business opportunities.